

6 280100 002316

MONDAY

AUGUST 3, 2026
SAFAR 19, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES



Cargo, Courier,
Shipping, logistics

800 916
www.abccargo.com

3154585 141

Mohamed, Zelensky discuss peace efforts

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received a phone call from President of Ukraine Volodymyr Zelensky, during which the two leaders discussed strengthening cooperation across various fields in support of mutual interests under the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement between the two countries.

Reviewing latest developments

Sheikh Mohamed and Zelensky also reviewed the latest developments in the Ukraine crisis and the humanitarian implications of the ongoing conflict.

Zelensky thanked Sheikh Mohamed for the UAE's continued diplomatic efforts to facilitate prisoner exchanges between the Russian Federation and Ukraine, as well as its sustained focus on addressing the humanitarian aspects of the crisis.

Advancing regional and global peace

The two leaders also exchanged views on a number of regional and international issues of joint interest and underscored the importance of intensifying efforts to advance regional and global peace, security, and stability in support of the well-being and development of peoples around the world.

— WAM



AP

■ Palestinians inspect destroyed buildings at the scene of an Israeli airstrike, at Al Maghazi refugee camp, central Gaza Strip, on Saturday. Overnight Israeli strikes on Gaza hit multiple residential buildings and killed at least 13 people, despite Hamas saying it agreed to US President Donald Trump's plan to end the war. Israel, on the other hand, shared 'serious security concerns' with the White House regarding the proposed disarmament deal with Hamas.

UAE hails Gaza disarmament deal

MoFA backs Trump-led accord linking Hamas disarmament to Israeli troop pullout

ABU DHABI

The UAE has welcomed the announcement by US President Donald Trump that the Board of Peace has reached a historic agreement on the disarmament of Hamas and other armed groups in the Gaza Strip as part of Trump's 20-point peace plan to end the war in Gaza.

The UAE affirmed that this step represents a significant milestone towards ending the conflict, reinforcing security and stability, and paving the

way for the launch of a political process leading to sustainable peace. In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) expressed the UAE's appreciation for Trump's leadership in supporting efforts to reach this agreement and commended the intensive endeavours of Qatar, Egypt, and Turkey, which facilitated an understanding between the parties.

Phased process

The Ministry expressed its hope that the agreement — which sets out a phased disarmament process, the concurrent withdrawal of Israeli forces, and the deployment of an international stabilisation force alongside a new Palestinian police force to secure the Gaza Strip — will help reinforce se-

curity and stability and bring an end to the suffering of civilians.

The Ministry also expressed hope that it will foster an environment conducive to reconstruction.

The Ministry reaffirmed the UAE's unwavering position in support of all regional and international efforts aimed at de-escalating tensions and achieving a just and comprehensive peace, emphasising the importance of ensuring the urgent, intensive, safe, and unhindered delivery of humanitarian and relief aid to Palestinians in the Strip.

These efforts advance a just and lasting political settlement based on the two-state solution, bringing security, stability, and prosperity to the peoples of the region, it said.

— WAM
SEE ALSO P4, 6

TRUMP SAYS US, ISRAEL TO HOLD OFF ON IRAN STRIKES

Hormuz reopening and end to Iran's nuclear threat part of proposed deal

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

US President Donald Trump said Saturday that the United States and Israel had agreed to hold off on new strikes on Iran — provided that a deal to end the months-long conflict is reached rapidly.

Trump insisted the US was “locked and loaded and ready to go against the Islamic Republic of Iran,” but added that “we have just been asked by Iran, and other Middle Eastern Countries, to hold off any attack”.

“Based on this request, I have agreed, for the future benefit of the WORLD and, likewise, the survival of a successful and prosperous Iran, to cancel the attack, subject to being able to rapidly make a DEAL,” Trump posted on his Truth Social platform. Iran's Mehr news agency, citing military officials, called Trump's claim that Tehran asked him to refrain “nothing but a new lie”.

Prioritising dialogue

Saudi Arabia's official SPA press agency said Crown Prince Mohammed Bin Salman had a call with Trump where he “emphasised the necessity of prioritising dialogue to reduce tensions and the importance of exerting all possible efforts to achieve a truce that paves the

GARGASH CALLS FOR GCC UNITY

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, on Saturday called for GCC unity in a post on X ahead of the 36th anniversary of Iraq's invasion of Kuwait on August 2.

“Tomorrow marks the anniversary of the invasion and occupation of our sisterly Kuwait, an occasion on which we recall the value of Gulf solidarity and the unity of our security and stability. Today, amid the challenges surrounding us, those lessons appear more urgent than ever. The destiny of the GCC states is shared, and the ship that carries us can only be saved through cooperation, coordination and unity,” he wrote.

—Gulf News Report

way for diplomatic solutions”. Trump said the deal would have to include the “Immediate, Complete and Total OPENING OF THE HORMUZ STRAIT, and an end to Iran's nuclear threat.”

Earlier, the UAE condemned the Iranian hostile attack targeting Kuwait with drones.

SEE ALSO P6

NATION

Dubai Metro city's favourite ride as public transport hits record high | P3



IN FOCUS

UAE doctors explain the risks of 'supplement stacking' | P8-9

Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E-mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Dubai beats NYC to become world's 2nd smartest city

Scores on AI adoption, smart city innovation

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai has been ranked the world's second most intelligent city in a new global study by Boston Consulting Group (BCG), placing ahead of New York City, Washington and Amsterdam in the consultancy's inaugural Intelligent Cities Index.

Only London ranked higher than Dubai in the assessment, which evaluated how 61 of the world's biggest cities use AI, digital technology and governance to improve life for residents and businesses.

The study assessed cities across five areas — outcomes, strategy, adoption, ways of working and enablers — before grouping them into four maturity levels: leading, accelerating, emerging and developing.

According to the report, Dubai was among only five

cities to achieve the highest “leading” maturity level overall, while Abu Dhabi ranked 20th globally, placing it in the “accelerating” maturity cohort.

Abu Dhabi also ranked among the world's top 10 for intelligent city enablers, reflecting the strength of its technology, infrastructure, funding, ecosystem and talent foundations.



The report identifies Dubai as one of the global leaders in adoption of smart city applications and AI technologies. According to BCG, Dubai rolls out more smart city use cases than most cities in the study, making adoption a key pillar of its overall approach to becoming an intelligent city.

The report also notes that Dubai scores highly for resident satisfaction with smart city apps, with frequent usage creating a positive cycle that encourages wider adoption and better services.

Al Asal marbles
A Building Materials Trading Co. L.L.C.

CALACATTA VIOLA
Bold. Luxurious. Authentic.

MARBLE | TRAVERTINE | QUARTZ | GRANITE | LIMESTONE | ONYX | QUARTZITE | SANDSTONE

info@alasalmarbles.com | Sajja Industrial Area, Sharjah, UAE | Contact Us: +971 6 534 5581

3154480_121